our fair share of the way to insure that our meeting is a productive one.

I do, however, want to address your response to the proposals we have previously made in the Geneva arms control talks, which were foreshadowed in your letter and which your delegation subsequently tabled in Geneva. We have been assessing your counterproposal over the past month. As I stated in my address to the United Nations on Oct. 24, I believe that within it there are seeds which we should nurture and that in the coming weeks we should seek to establish a genuine process of give and take.

In order to foster such a process, I have approved a new and comprehensive proposal designed to build upon the positive elements of your counterproposal and bridge the positions of our two sides. I have asked our negotiators to extend the current round to permit your experts to achieve a full understanding of our approach. This new proposal deals with all three areas under discussion in the Geneva negotiations. Its essence is a proposal for radical and stabilizing reductions in strategic offensive arms and a separate agreement on intermediate range missile systems, both of which bridge U.S. and Soviet ideas. We also propose that both sides provide assurances that their strategic defense programs are and will remain in full accord with the ABM treaty. Such assurances assume a resolution of our current differences over compliance with the treaty.

In the area of strategic arms, the United States agrees with the objective of a fifty per cent reduction of strategic offensive forces. Our proposal builds on this, applying the fifty per cent principle in a manner that is both equitable and can enhance stability. In the area of intermediate range nuclear forces, we have also looked